Digital Literacy Project Report – CSE0001

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Introduction

This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The scenario placed me in the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for guiding peers in navigating the digital world safely and professionally. The project required me to complete five tasks, each focusing on a different aspect of digital literacy: awareness, professional portfolio building, coding and collaboration, communication etiquette, and cybercrime prevention. All tasks were documented in this report and organized in a GitHub repository. Through this project, I gained practical exposure to digital tools, improved my online presence, and developed a deeper understanding of responsible digital practices.

Task 1: Infographic Creation

I created a one-page infographic using Canva. The infographic highlighted three key aspects of digital literacy: safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. I used icons and concise text to make the design visually appealing and easy to understand.

- **Safe Internet Practices:** Emphasized strong passwords and avoiding suspicious links.
- **Professional Presence:** Showed how platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub can help students build credibility.
- **Email Etiquette:** Included a checklist of rules such as clear subject lines and professional greetings.

The main challenge was balancing text and visuals. Initially, the design felt cluttered, but after simplifying, I realized that clarity is more impactful than excessive detail. This task taught me how visual communication can make digital concepts engaging and accessible.

Task 2: Building a Digital Portfolio

I built my student digital portfolio by creating accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

- **GitHub:** Set up a profile README with my name, branch, year, and a short statement about my learning goals.
- **LinkedIn:** Added education details, including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year.
- **Kaggle:** Created a profile to explore datasets and competitions.

Screenshots of each profile were added to the repository. These platforms serve different purposes: GitHub showcases coding projects, LinkedIn builds professional networks, and Kaggle supports data science practice. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to maintain my portfolio, LinkedIn to connect with peers and recruiters, and Kaggle to strengthen my analytical skills. This task helped me understand the importance of maintaining a professional digital presence early in my academic journey.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration

For Part A, I registered on HackerRank and completed the beginner challenge **"Solve Me First."** This gave me confidence in using online coding platforms and provided a badge as proof of completion.

For Part B, I created a Google Form quiz titled **"Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz"** with five questions, including multiple choice and short answer formats. I linked the form to a Google Sheet to collect responses. Screenshots of both were added to the repository.

These tools are academically useful because coding platforms allow practice and skill development, while Google Forms enable collaboration and feedback collection. This task showed me how digital platforms can support both individual learning and group engagement. It also reinforced the importance of combining technical practice with collaborative tools to enhance productivity.

Task 4: Communication Etiquette

I drafted two professional emails:

1. Requesting an extension on an assignment deadline (to a professor).
2. Expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity (to a coordinator).

Both emails followed proper etiquette: clear subject lines, professional greetings, structured body, and polite sign-offs.

Additionally, I created a **social media checklist** with five do's and five don'ts for responsible online behaviour. One scenario I reflected on was when poor communication on social media led to misunderstandings and reputational damage. The situation could have been avoided by using respectful language and verifying information before posting. This task emphasized the importance of professionalism in both formal emails and informal digital communication.

Task 5: Cybercrime Prevention

I researched **cyberbullying** as a case study. Cyberbullying involves harassment through digital platforms, often targeting vulnerable students by spreading rumours, posting humiliating content, or sending threatening messages. The consequences include anxiety, depression, and academic decline.

I documented the case study in the repository and created a **Stay Safe Online checklist** with eight tips, including two specific to UPI/financial safety:

- Verify recipient details before payments.
- Avoid unknown QR codes.

The checklist also included official reporting channels such as the **National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)** and **Helpline 1930**.

What surprised me most was how quickly harmful content can spread online and remain permanently accessible. As a result, I plan to change my habit of oversharing personal details on social media.

Conclusion

This project provided me with practical exposure to digital tools and platforms while reinforcing the importance of safe and professional online practices. Each task contributed to my growth as a Student Digital Ambassador:

- Designing infographics improved my communication skills.
- Building portfolios strengthened my professional presence.
- Coding challenges enhanced my technical confidence.
- Email drafting refined my etiquette.
- Cybercrime research deepened my awareness of online threats.

Overall, the project taught me that digital literacy is not just about using tools but about using them responsibly, effectively, and thoughtfully.

References

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- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930